

LISTENING

#24

1 – Listen to a report about young Ugandan students learning to build simple robots. Pay attention to how the program works, what Solomon says about creativity, and how students respond to hands-on learning.

Building Robots in Schools

1 - What does the presenter say Fundi Bots does in order to encourage children's hands-on skills?

- a) Teach them how to take exams
- b) Give them materials and support to build robots
- c) Train them to become teachers

2 - How long ago did Solomon found Fundi Bots?

- a) Three years ago
- b) Seven years ago
- c) Ten years ago

3 - What does the man say about toys from his childhood?

4 - What does the robot in the workshop do when it detects an obstacle?

- a) It turns off
- b) It initiates collision avoidance
- c) It asks for help

5 - What does the man say children realize once they've built a robot?

- a) They can make it react to light or sound
- b) They should focus on exam grades
- c) Building robots is too difficult

6 - According to the man, what do many schools mainly focus on?

7 - The man says education should be about:

- a) Getting top grades
- b) Knowledge and how to apply it
- c) Competing with other students

8 - What is the man's opinion about children taking devices apart, like radios?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

The African Robotics Club Inspiring Kids to Innovate

Across several African countries, robotics initiatives are transforming the way young people engage with science and technology. These programs aim to shift learning away from theory-heavy education systems and toward a more practical, problem-solving approach. In many schools, students spend years preparing for exams, yet have limited opportunities to experiment, build, or investigate how machines actually work. Robotics clubs attempt to change this by giving students direct access to tools, components, and mentors who guide them through hands-on projects.

One of the standout examples comes from community-driven workshops that focus on low-cost innovation. Many students begin with almost no experience in engineering, but the moment they assemble a simple robot or program a small sensor, their confidence grows rapidly. Teachers involved in these programs say that robotics helps students understand that technology is not something distant or foreign; it is something they can shape with their own ideas.

A significant part of the movement's success comes from its emphasis on real-world challenges. Students are encouraged to design robots that address issues in their communities, such as detecting contaminated water, assisting local farmers, or monitoring environmental changes. This practical orientation helps them see technology as a tool for social improvement rather than just entertainment.

These programs also aim to make the field more inclusive. Girls, in particular, are being encouraged to join robotics teams, and many have gone on to compete in regional competitions. Mentors say that exposure at an early age can spark long-term interest in engineering, computer science, and entrepreneurship.

Supporters of these initiatives believe that African-led innovation will grow stronger if young people receive the right combination of curiosity, guidance, and resources. By learning to build and experiment, students across the continent are developing the skills and confidence needed for the next generation of technological leadership.

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Comprehension Questions

1. What problem do robotics programs try to fix in many African schools?

2. What helps students gain confidence when learning robotics?

3. What kinds of community problems do some students design robots for?

4. Do you think hands-on learning is more effective than traditional theory-based classes? Why or why not?

5. How would you feel about joining a robotics club yourself?
